

TRADE & SERVICE CRM

User Manual

A practical guide to the day-to-day workflows for office staff, dispatchers, field technicians, and customers.

Covers: Admin Dashboard · Technician App · Customer Portal

Extended edition — includes flow diagrams for the most-used workflows and a full walkthrough of scheduling & dispatching.

Generated: August 6, 2026

CONTENTS

Table of Contents

1. How the System Fits Together

Roles & who does what

The core job lifecycle

2. Getting Started

Logging in to each app

Technician sign-up & approval

3. Office & Admin Workflows (Admin Dashboard)

Leads & Customers

Jobs

Scheduling & Dispatching

Projects

Agreements (Service Contracts)

Finance — Quotes, Invoices, Payments, Expenses

Inventory & Purchase Orders

Communications

Analytics & Reports

Import Wizard

Team & Company Settings

4. Technician App (Mobile)

Home & My Jobs

Working a Job

Van Stock, Messages & Expenses

Working with a weak connection

5. Customer Portal

Getting an account & signing in

Booking a service

Tracking jobs, quotes & invoices

Paying an invoice

Messages & profile

6. Automated & AI-Assisted Workflows

7. Status & Terminology Glossary

8. Known Limitations & FAQ

How the System Fits Together

The CRM is made of three applications that share one underlying database. Office staff and dispatchers work in the **Admin Dashboard** (web), field technicians work in the **Technician App** (phone), and customers work in the **Customer Portal** (web). Every action any of them takes — booking a job, updating a status, sending a message — is visible to the others in real time.

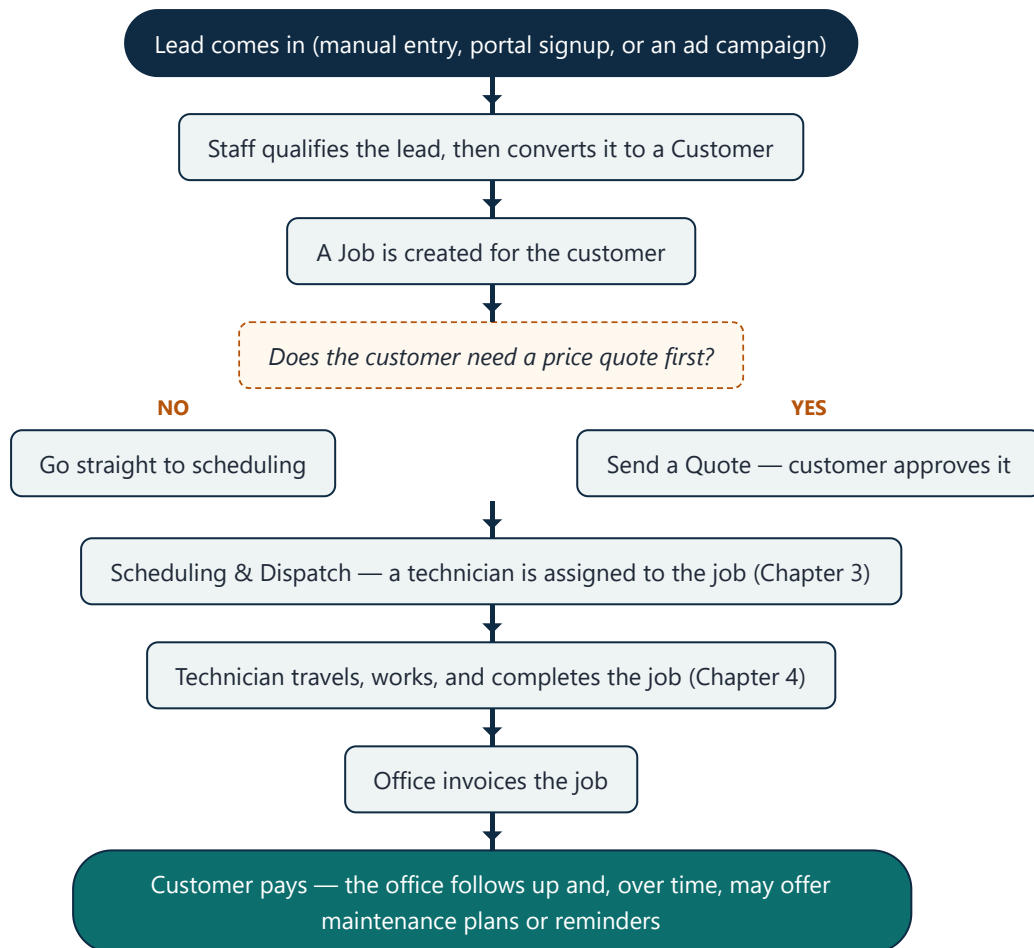
Roles & Who Does What

Role	App	Typical responsibilities
super_admin	Admin Dashboard	Full access; only role that can manage other super_admins.
company_admin	Admin Dashboard	Runs the company: team, settings, finance, all modules.
office_manager	Admin Dashboard	Day-to-day: leads, customers, jobs, finance, agreements.
dispatcher	Admin Dashboard	Assigns and tracks jobs on the Dispatch Board and Day Planner.
technician	Technician App	Works assigned jobs in the field, logs parts/notes, messages the office.
customer	Customer Portal	Books service, tracks visits, pays invoices, messages the office.

NOTE — In the Admin Dashboard, every signed-in staff role currently sees the same menu — access is not hidden by role, except that only a super_admin's own account is protected from being demoted or deleted by others.

The Core Job Lifecycle

Almost everything in this manual is a step in one continuous story — a prospect becomes a customer, a customer gets a job, a job gets a technician, and a completed job turns into revenue. Keep this flow in mind as you read; later chapters go module-by-module through each step of it.



A parallel loop runs from the customer's side: they can log into the Customer Portal, book a new service themselves, approve a quote, or pay an invoice — which re-enters this same chain at the Job or Quote step.

Getting Started

Logging In

App	Who	Notes
Admin Dashboard	Staff (all office roles)	Email + password. Accounts are created by an admin under Team.
Technician App	Technicians	Email + password, or self-register (see below).
Customer Portal	Customers	Email + password. Accounts are set up by the company — there is no public "Sign Up" button in the portal; contact your service provider to get access.

If an admin created your account for you (staff or technician), your first login uses a temporary password and you will be forced to set a new one before you can continue.

NOTE — Once you're logged in, you can change your password yourself at any time (you'll need your current one): staff and technicians from their Profile menu, customers from Profile → Security in the portal. If you're locked out and can't log in at all, there's no self-service "forgot password" link on the login screen — ask your company admin to reset it for you; that sets you up with a temporary password you'll be prompted to replace.

Technician Sign-Up & Approval

Technicians can self-register from the Technician App instead of waiting for an admin to create their account.

1. Open the app and choose **Sign Up**. Complete the 3-step form: (1) name, email, phone, password; (2) your skill tags (HVAC, Plumbing, Electrical, etc.) and optionally a profile photo; (3) your base location, pinned on a map or found by address search.
2. Submit. You'll land on an **Almost There** screen showing your application status (Submitted → Admin reviews → Activated). Typical review time is about 24 hours.
3. An office admin reviews your application under **Team** in the Admin Dashboard and either approves or rejects it. Approval automatically provisions a van/stock location for you.
4. Once approved, tap **"I've Been Approved — Sign In"** on the pending screen, or just log in normally.

If your account was instead created directly by an office admin, you skip the approval wait — you'll just be asked to set your own password and base location the first time you log in.

Office & Admin Workflows — Admin Dashboard

This is the main workspace for office staff and dispatchers. The left-hand menu covers every module below.

| Leads & Customers

Add a new lead or customer

1. Go to **Customers & CRM** and click **Add Customer**.
2. Choose **Lead** if this is a prospect who hasn't been sold yet — enter their email (required) and details; the system checks the email isn't already in use, then creates the CRM login, the Lead record, and sends them a welcome email. Choose **Customer** to add someone directly as an active customer.

Convert a lead to a customer

1. Click the lead in the list to open its details panel (tabs: Contact, Addresses, Activity, Reasoning).
2. Click **Convert**. The lead becomes a full Customer record and the panel switches to the new customer.

Manage an existing customer

Click any customer row to open their full record: Contact, Addresses, Equipment, Jobs, Agreements, Projects, Reviews, Activity, and Reasoning tabs. From here you can edit contact details inline, tag the customer, add/edit their equipment, review linked service agreements, or start a new job for them directly.

Each customer row also has a **Follow-up** toggle to turn automatic follow-up on/off for that customer, and a **Recommendations** (sparkle icon) button that opens AI-generated suggestions — churn risk, upsell offers, and retention actions — described further in Chapter 6.

Jobs

Create a job

Click + **New Job** from the Jobs page, from a customer's record, or from the Dispatch Board — all open the same job form.

Manage a job

Click any job to open its workspace, organized into tabs:

Tab	What you do there
Overview	Change status, set priority, add notes.
Checklist	Add and complete work-order tasks; mark which are required.
Equipment	Add/edit/remove customer equipment tied to this job.
Inventory	Consume, transfer, or return stock (van vs. warehouse) against this job.
Finance	Create a Quote or Invoice from the job, or send an existing one.
Notes	Free-text internal notes.
Activity	Full status-history timeline.
Customer	Quick view of the customer this job belongs to.

Use **Chat with Tech** inside a job to jump straight into a message thread with the assigned technician. Cancelling a job asks for a reason; a "parts shortage" flag can be toggled if a job is stuck waiting on stock.

Scheduling & Dispatching

This is where an unassigned job gets a technician and a time. The Dispatch Board is the main screen for it, and it gives you a few different ways to actually get the job scheduled and tracked — pick whichever fits how you work.

Ways to assign a technician

Method	How it works	Best for
Smart Assign	Click it on a pending job and the system scores nearby technicians on distance (40%), current workload (35%), and rating (25%). If the best match scores 90+, they're auto-assigned immediately. Otherwise you'll see the top 3 candidates with their score breakdown — click Assign This Tech on the one you want.	The fast default for routine jobs — let the system do the matching.
Manual Assign	Skip the scoring and pick a technician directly from the list.	Jobs with a specific requirement (a customer's regular tech, a specialist skill, an urgent reshuffle) where you already know who should go.

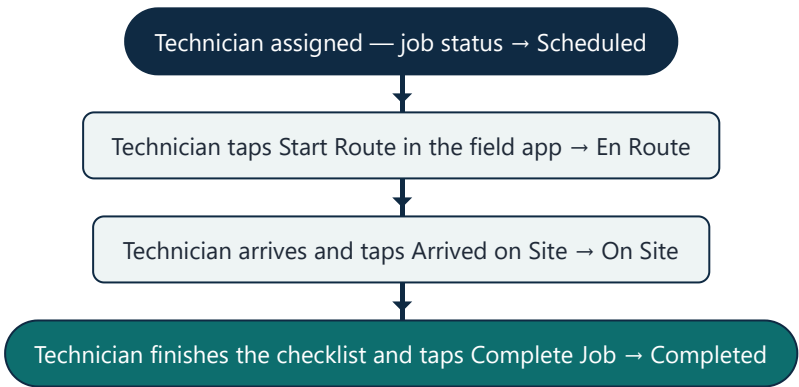
Ways to view and run your schedule

View	What it shows
List	The default — every job in a sortable, filterable table. Good for working through a queue of unassigned jobs.
Map	Jobs and technicians plotted spatially, so you can see who's actually close to a given job before assigning.
Calendar	A time-based grid — good for seeing gaps and overlaps in a technician's day at a glance.
Day Planner	A separate page showing a route-optimized daily schedule per technician on a map — use it to tighten up a day's driving route before it starts, rather than while triaging incoming jobs.

Toggle between List, Map, and Calendar at the top of the Dispatch Board; Day Planner is its own item in the left menu. **New Technician** on the Dispatch Board adds a tech to the pool without leaving the page.

Tracking a job once it's assigned

Every assignment moves through the same live lifecycle, whether it got there via Smart Assign or Manual Assign:



You can watch this update live from the Dispatch Board's job card — no need to refresh. A dispatcher can also reassign a job at any point if plans change; the previous technician is freed up and the job returns to the unassigned pool.

NOTE — Technician cards show a live availability tier — Online (<15 min since last ping), Available (<8h), Away (<24h), or Offline (24h+) — so you can see who's realistically reachable before assigning, on whichever view you're using.

Projects

Groups several related jobs (e.g. a multi-day install, or a maintenance agreement's recurring visits) under one project record so you can track them — and their combined budget and crew — as a single unit instead of chasing each job separately.

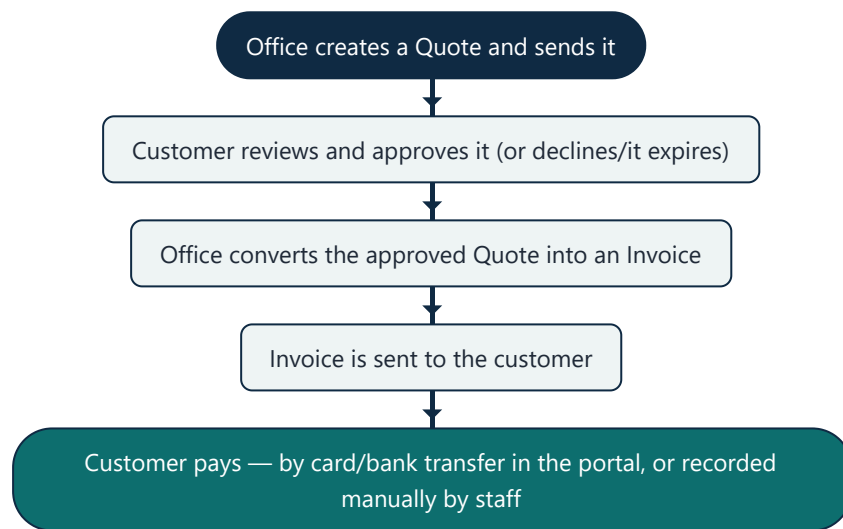
Agreements (Service Contracts)

1. Click + **New Agreement**, set the plan terms (e.g. an annual maintenance plan) and link it to a customer.
2. Send it — the customer reviews and signs it from their own portal.
3. Track status via the filter chips: Active, Awaiting Confirmation, Drafts, Pending Renewal, Expired, Cancelled.
4. Open any agreement to see its visit meter (visits used vs. included), amendment history, and to renew or cancel it.

An agreement that lapses into **Expired** without renewal is one of the triggers the automatic follow-up agent watches for (Chapter 6).

Finance — Quotes, Invoices, Payments, Expenses

The money side of a job usually follows the same path from quote to cash in hand:



A job doesn't strictly need a quote — you can invoice directly from a completed job when the price was already agreed.

Create a quote or invoice

1. From the Finance page (or from a job's Finance tab), click + **New** and choose Quote or Invoice.
2. Add line items (description, category, quantity, unit price) and a tax rate — totals calculate live.

Quote → Invoice

Open a quote and click **Approve** once the customer has agreed, then **Convert to Invoice** to turn it into a billable invoice. You can also Download or Send the PDF directly from here.

Recording a payment

Open an invoice (must be Sent, Partially Paid, or Overdue) and go to its **Record Payment** tab. Enter the amount, payment method (including Cash), and a reference note, then confirm. Invoices can also be Voided or Sent from the same screen.

NOTE — Staff record payments manually here — there is no in-app card-charge screen for staff. Customers pay online themselves through the Customer Portal (Chapter 5), and that payment shows up on the invoice automatically.

Expenses

Log technician or job-related expenses with + **New Expense**; each one goes through an approve/reject/paid workflow before it's settled.

Inventory & Purchase Orders

Tab	What it's for
Items	Your full parts/materials/tools/consumables catalog, with per-location stock.
Movements	Full history: intake, transfer, consume, adjust, return.
Purchase Orders	Draft → Ordered → Partial → Received. Receiving a PO books the stock back in.
Low Stock	Reorder alerts for anything running low.

Use **Intake Stock** to receive new stock into a warehouse or van, and **Transfer Stock** to move stock between locations (e.g. warehouse → a technician's van). Click any item for its full movement history and to make manual adjustments.

Communications

Two panes: **Threads** (conversations with customers or team members) and **Notifications** (system alerts). Click **New Message** to start a thread with any customer or staff member. Threads can be marked Active, Resolved, or Spam, and update live as messages arrive. A floating chat icon on every page gives you quick access without leaving what you're doing.

Analytics & Reports

Read-only dashboards: revenue trend, jobs by status, technician leaderboard, customer acquisition, and revenue-by-category, plus an AI "Revenue Agent" summary. Toggle between year and month views. Nothing here is editable — it's for reporting and spotting trends.

Import Wizard

Under **Integrations** → **Import**, bring in customers/equipment from a spreadsheet in five guided steps: **Source** → **Upload** → **Map Columns** → **Validate** → **Import**. Validation errors are shown before anything is committed, and a completed import batch can be rolled back later from the admin import-history view if something went wrong.

Team & Company Settings

Team is where you manage staff and technician accounts: add a member, edit their role, and — for self-registered technicians — **Approve** or **Reject** pending applications (a red dot on the Team menu item flags pending approvals). Approving a technician also sets up their van automatically.

Settings covers your company profile, notification preferences, appearance/theme, security, job checklist templates, customer-portal banner text, AI-agent configuration, and integrations (e.g. connecting/disconnecting QuickBooks).

Technician App (Mobile)

The field app has six tabs: **Home**, **My Jobs**, **Van Stock**, **Messages**, **Alerts**, and **Profile**.

NOTE — Allow location access when the app asks for it — it's what powers your live availability tier on the dispatch side (Chapter 3), turn-by-turn directions to a job, and your live position showing up for the office and customer once you tap Start Route.

Home & My Jobs

Home greets you with today's stats (jobs today, active, done, your rating), an active-job banner if you're currently en route or on site, a "Next Up" card with a one-tap **Get Directions**, and your schedule for the day. Pull down to refresh.

My Jobs lists everything assigned to you under Today / Upcoming / Completed tabs, with search. Tap any job to open it.

Working a Job

A job opens into six tabs — Overview, Checklist, Parts, Equipment, Stock, and Notes — plus one big action button at the bottom that always shows your next step:

Job is at...	Button does...	Result
Scheduled	Start Route	Status → En Route, opens turn-by-turn navigation.
En Route	Arrived on Site	Status → On Site.
On Site / In Progress	Complete Job	Checks all required checklist items are done, asks you to confirm, then marks the job Completed.

- **Checklist** — work-order tasks with a progress bar; required tasks must be checked off before you can complete the job.
- **Parts** — add parts/labor line items from the price book as you use them; running total updates live.
- **Equipment** — read-only view of the customer's equipment on file.
- **Stock** — mark stock as collected for this job, see whether your van has enough of what's needed, and return unused stock to the warehouse.
- **Notes** — separate fields for customer-facing notes and private internal notes.

LIMITATION — Completing a job is checklist-plus-confirmation only — there is currently no in-app photo or signature capture step at job completion. (Photo capture does exist for expense receipts and your profile photo.)

| Van Stock, Messages & Expenses

Van Stock shows what's loaded on your assigned van — on-hand, reserved, and available quantities, low-stock flags, and a full movement history.

Messages lets you chat with the office or with a customer on a specific job, with live delivery. **Alerts** shows job assignments, schedule changes, and other system notifications — this list refreshes automatically every 30 seconds while the app is open.

To log an **expense** (fuel, parts, tools, permits, etc.), open the expense form from the relevant screen, fill in category/amount/vendor, optionally link it to a job, snap a photo of the receipt, and submit for approval.

| Working with a Weak Connection

The app keeps the last day of data cached, so your job list and details still show something useful if you briefly lose signal. As soon as you're back online, everything refreshes automatically.

LIMITATION — This caching is read-only. If you try to change a job's status, tick off a checklist item, or save a note while you have no connection at all, that action will fail immediately with an on-screen alert rather than being queued and retried later — make sure you have signal before submitting updates.

Customer Portal

Getting an Account & Signing In

Customer accounts are set up by the company — there's no public sign-up form in the portal itself. Once your account exists, log in with your email and password. If the company set a temporary password for you, you'll be asked to choose your own before continuing.

Booking a Service

Click **Book a Service** from the Dashboard or My Jobs page. It's a 3-step form:

1. **Service** — pick a type (Maintenance, Repair, Installation, Inspection, Emergency), give it a short title, and optionally link a piece of equipment already on your profile.
2. **When** — pick a date and a preferred arrival window (Morning/Afternoon/Evening), and choose a saved address or enter a new one.
3. **Review** — confirm the summary, add access notes (gate code, pets, parking), pin the exact location on the map, and submit.

Submitting doesn't charge you anything — the company will confirm the time and send you a firm estimate afterward.

Tracking Jobs, Quotes & Invoices

My Jobs is split into Active / Upcoming / Past. An active job shows a live 5-step tracker: Booked → Confirmed → En Route → On Site → Done. You can cancel a job yourself while it's still pending or scheduled.

Quotes lists everything sent to you for approval — open one to review the line items, then **Accept** or **Decline** it directly.

Invoices lists everything you owe or have paid, with filters and PDF download.

Paying an Invoice

Open the invoice and click **Pay** (only shown if the company has online payments turned on). Choose:

- **Card** — opens a secure Stripe checkout window; the portal automatically detects when payment succeeds and updates the invoice without you needing to refresh.
- **Bank Transfer** — shows the company's bank details and a reference number to use, with an optional receipt upload. This is confirmed manually by the office, usually within 1–2 business days.

Partial payments are supported and shown clearly on the invoice.

Messages & Profile

Messages lets you chat with the office (default) or with a specific technician assigned to your job. A live/connecting indicator shows whether you're currently receiving real-time updates.

Profile has three tabs: **Personal** (your contact details and push-notification preference), **Equipment** (add/edit the equipment installed at your property so technicians arrive prepared), and **Security** (change your password).

Also available: **Agreements** (your service contracts — including a one-click email confirmation link for new agreements), **Projects** (multi-visit jobs tracked as one unit), and read-only **Tips** and **Offers** feeds from the company.

Automated & AI-Assisted Workflows

A few things happen in the background without anyone clicking a button. Understanding them helps explain the suggestions and toggles staff see in the Admin Dashboard — and, if you're a customer, why you might occasionally get a maintenance reminder, a follow-up call, or an offer you didn't explicitly request.

Automatic Follow-Up

Runs every few hours and checks every customer/lead against four triggers: a cold lead with no contact (`LEAD_FOLLOWUP`), a quote sent but never answered (`QUOTE_FOLLOWUP`), a service agreement that expired (`RETENTION`), or a customer inactive for 90+ days (`REENGAGEMENT`). When a trigger fires, it decides the best channel, priority, and message, then queues the outreach. Turn this on/off per customer with the Follow-up toggle in Customers & CRM.

Upsell Recommendations

Runs daily and suggests one of three offers — a maintenance plan, a replacement, or a service visit — based on equipment age, spend history, and risk signals. High-confidence recommendations (above 75%) are queued automatically; others appear as suggestions for staff to act on via the Recommendations panel on a customer's record.

Retention / Churn-Risk

Flags customers at risk of leaving and suggests a retention action (premium contract offer, discount, maintenance plan offer, or no action). This scoring is currently rule-based (using signals like days since last service and spend), not a live machine-learning model — treat it as a helpful prioritization signal, not a certainty.

NOTE — These three systems are what power the churn-risk colors, upsell badges, and retention suggestions you see throughout the Customers & CRM page.

Status & Terminology Glossary

Statuses are consistent across every app — a job marked `EN_ROUTE` on the Dispatch Board is the exact same status a technician and customer see on their own screens.

Entity	Statuses (in order)
Lead	NEW → CONTACTED → QUALIFIED → WON (or LOST)
Job	PENDING → SCHEDULED → EN_ROUTE → ON_SITE → COMPLETED → INVOICED → PAID (or CANCELLED / ON_HOLD)
Job priority	LOW, NORMAL, HIGH, EMERGENCY
Dispatch assignment	SUGGESTED → ASSIGNED → EN_ROUTE → ON_SITE → COMPLETED (or CANCELLED)
Quote	DRAFT → SENT → VIEWED → ACCEPTED / DECLINED / EXPIRED → CONVERTED
Invoice	DRAFT → SENT → PARTIALLY_PAID / OVERDUE → PAID (or VOID)
Payment	PENDING → SUCCEEDED / FAILED / REFUNDED
Service Agreement	DRAFT → SENT → ACTIVE → PENDING_RENEWAL → RENEWED / EXPIRED / CANCELLED
Purchase Order	DRAFT → ORDERED → PARTIAL → RECEIVED (or CANCELLED)
Technician approval	PENDING → APPROVED / REJECTED
Message thread	ACTIVE / RESOLVED / SPAM

Known Limitations & FAQ

Question	Answer
Why can't a customer sign themselves up in the portal?	The portal has no public sign-up form today — accounts must be created by the company. (New leads captured any other way, e.g. a phone call, are entered by staff under Customers & CRM.)
Why doesn't card payment work in my test/dev environment?	Stripe isn't configured in local development by default — the payment screen falls back gracefully so the rest of the flow can still be tested; live/staging environments have Stripe fully wired up.
Can a technician take a completion photo or get a signature in the app?	Not currently — job completion is checklist-plus-confirmation only. Photos exist for expense receipts and profile pictures, not job sign-off.
Does the technician app work fully offline?	It shows cached data while offline, but status changes, checklist updates, and notes require an active connection to save — they are not queued for later sync.
Does the technician app send push notifications?	Not yet — the Alerts tab polls for new notifications every 30 seconds while the app is open.
Where do I see machine-learning performance for the follow-up/upsell/retention agents?	The AI Ops dashboard exists at <code>/bandit-dashboard</code> but isn't in the main menu — it's intended for technical/ML-ops staff, not day-to-day use.